

[Lesson 41](#): “Every Member a Missionary” (See L41 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To inspire us to participate in taking the gospel to all the world and to strengthen new converts.

†1. President Spencer W. Kimball [Pictures of our Church Presidents](#)

1. The Church is coming forth out of obscurity.

- D&C 1:30. That we “might have power ... to bring it forth out of obscurity and out of darkness”.
 - D&C 65:1-6. “Pray unto the Lord, ... make known his wonderful works... Call upon the Lord, that his kingdom may go forth upon the earth that the inhabitants thereof may receive it, and be prepared for ... the Son of Man”.
 - D&C 109:72-74. The “church may come ... out of the wilderness of darkness, and shine forth fair as the moon”.
- †2. The Prophet Joseph Smith In what ways is the Church coming out of obscurity throughout the world?

2. Latter-day prophets have challenged us to take the gospel to all the world.

- Read about missionary work under President David O. McKay, in *Our Heritage*, [pages 116-17](#).
 - Read about President Spencer W. Kimball’s address to regional representatives, in *Our Heritage*, [page 125](#).
- †3. President Gordon B. Hinckley

How are these prophecies of the gospel filling the earth being fulfilled?

(The Philippines are an outstanding example. Consider the “miracle in Manila.” There were a handful of members in 1961. 20,000 members in 1975 “[Philippines: The Land of Joyous Service](#),” *Ensign*, Aug. 1975. 300,000 members in 1992, Elder Augusto A. Lim “[Missionary Work in the Philippines](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1992. (Note President Hinckley’s prophesy.) There are 675,166 members today “LDS Newsroom: Facts and Statistics: [Philippines](#)”.)

3. “Every member a missionary.”

- D&C 1:4-5; 88:81. “And a voice of warning shall be unto all the people.”

What can each of us do to assist in missionary work?

1. *Prepare to serve full-time missions* †4. President Spencer W. Kimball

How can we prepare ourselves to serve full-time missions? Why?

How can parents and other adults help young people prepare to be full-time missionaries?

2. *Serve full-time missions* †5. Elder David B. Haight

Who should serve full-time missions? “All worthy, able young men ages 19 through 25 should serve full-time missions. Full-time missionary service is a priesthood responsibility for these young men. Women ages 21 and older may also be recommended to serve full-time missions if they desire. Older couples are also encouraged to serve missions when they are able to do so. All missionaries must be worthy.” (*Lesson Manual*)

- Read about a missionary couple in the Philippines. Pres. Hinckley, “[The Healing Power of Christ](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1988.

3. *Support full-time missionaries* †6. President Gordon B. Hinckley

How can we support missionaries who are now serving?

4. *Share the gospel throughout our lives* †7. President Kimball †8. President Kimball

What experiences have you had sharing the gospel with others?

Why are we sometimes afraid to share the gospel and how can we overcome these fears?

What are some ways we can share the gospel with others? †9. Suggested Ways to Share the Gospel

4. Nurturing new converts is our continuing responsibility.

“Any investigator worthy of baptism becomes a convert worthy of saving” (Pres. Hinckley, “[Find the Lambs, Feed the Sheep](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 109.)

- Read the letter to President Gordon B. Hinckley in “[Some Thoughts on Temples, Retention of Converts, and Missionary Service](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997. †10. Ted L. Gibbons

Why is it sometimes difficult for new converts to stay active in the Church? †11. President Gordon B. Hinckley

What can new converts do to strengthen themselves?

What can other members do to strengthen new converts? †12. President Gordon B. Hinckley

If you are an adult convert from another faith, could you share the feelings you had as a new member?

- Read Elder Bruce Porter’s experience in Pres. Hinckley’s “[Find the Lambs, Feed the Sheep](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 107.

Next Week: L42: Continuing Revelation to Latter-day Prophets; See L42 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “When I read Church history, I am amazed at the boldness of the early brethren as they went out into the world. They seemed to find a way. ... As early as 1837 the Twelve were in England fighting Satan, in Tahiti in 1844, Australia in 1851, Iceland [in] 1853, Italy [in] 1850, and also in Switzerland, Germany, Tonga, Turkey, Mexico, Japan, Czechoslovakia, China, Samoa, New Zealand, South America, France, and Hawaii in 1850. ... Much of this early proselyting was done while the leaders were climbing the Rockies and planting the sod and starting their homes. It is faith and super faith” (“[When the World Will Be Converted](#),” *Ensign*, Oct. 1974, 6).

“Somehow, ... I feel that when we have done all in our power that the Lord will find a way to open doors. That is my faith” (“[When the World Will Be Converted](#),” *Ensign*, Oct. 1974, 7).

†2. **The Prophet Joseph Smith:** “No unhallowed hand can stop the work from progressing; persecutions may rage, mobs may combine, armies may assemble, calumny may defame, but the truth of God will go forth boldly, nobly, and independent, till it has penetrated every continent, visited every clime, swept every country, and sounded in every ear, till the purposes of God shall be accomplished, and the Great Jehovah shall say the work is done” (*History of the Church*, 4:540).

†3. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “Now, what of the future? What of the years that lie ahead? It looks promising indeed. People are beginning to see us for what we are and for the values we espouse. ...

“If we will go forward, never losing sight of our goal, speaking ill of no one, living the great principles we know to be true, this cause will roll on in majesty and power to fill the earth. Doors now closed to the preaching of the gospel will be opened. The Almighty, if necessary, may have to shake the nations to humble them and cause them to listen to the servants of the living God. Whatever is needed will come to pass.

“The key to the great challenges facing us and to the success of the work will be the faith of all who call themselves Latter-day Saints” (“[Look to the Future](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997, 68).

†4. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “When I ask for more missionaries, I am not asking for more testimony-barren or unworthy missionaries. I am asking that we start earlier and train our missionaries better in every branch and every ward in the world. ... Young people [should] understand that it is a great privilege to go on a mission and that they must be physically well, mentally well, spiritually well, and that ‘the Lord cannot look upon sin with the least degree of allowance’ [D&C 1:31]” (“[When the World Will Be Converted](#),” *Ensign*, Oct. 1974, 7).

†5. **Elder David B. Haight:** “The goal of every physically able couple in the Church, just as it is for every nineteen-year-old young man in the Church, should be to serve a mission. No finer example can be given, no finer testimony can be borne by parents to children or grandchildren, than through missionary service in their mature years” (“[My Neighbor—My Brother!](#)” *Ensign*, May 1987, 61).

†6. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “My brethren and sisters, we can let the missionaries try to do it alone, or we can help them. If they do it alone, they will knock on doors day after day and the harvest will be meager. Or as members we can assist them in finding and teaching investigators” (“[Find the Lambs, Feed the Sheep](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 107).

†7. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “It seems to me that the Lord chose his words when he said [that the gospel must go to] ‘every nation,’ ‘every land,’ ‘uttermost bounds of the earth,’ ‘every tongue,’ ‘every people,’ ‘every soul,’ ‘all the world,’ ‘many lands.’ Surely there is significance in these words! ... I wonder if we are doing all we can. Are we complacent in our approach to teaching all the world? ... Are we prepared to lengthen our stride? To enlarge our vision?” (“[When the World Will Be Converted](#),” *Ensign*, Oct. 1974, 5).

†8. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “Our great need, and our great calling, is to bring to the people of this world the candle of understanding to light their way out of obscurity and darkness and into the joy, peace, and truths of the gospel. I believe we must not weary in our well-doing. I believe it is time again to ask ourselves the question, what can I do to help take the gospel to others and to the inhabitants of the world?” (“[Are We Doing All We Can?](#)” *Ensign*, Feb. 1983, 5).

Recommended reading:

1. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[A Word for the Hesitant Missionary](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2013, 4.
2. Elder M. Russell Ballard, “[Put Your Trust in the Lord](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2013, 43.
3. President Gordon B. Hinckley, “[Find the Lambs, Feed the Sheep](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 107.

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†9. Suggested Ways to Share the Gospel:

- a. Set a good example for family members, neighbors, and friends.
- b. Share copies of the Book of Mormon.
- c. Refer names of interested people to the missionaries.
- d. Share your feelings about the gospel with people.
- e. Invite people to Church activities, meetings, and firesides.
- f. Invite people to family home evening and to neighborhood activities.
- g. Invite people who are interested in genealogy to visit a Family History Center.
- h. Invite people to baptismal services.
(*Lesson Manual*)

†10. Ted L. Gibbons: “When I served in Brazil, I worked in a wonderful branch filled with the spirit of missionary work. Once a month the Relief Society brought their husbands and went out visiting, inviting people to come to church or to accept a visit from the missionaries or to examine some church literature. When we were teaching a family, we took members with us to each of the discussions following the first one. We had members who were as committed to sharing the gospel as any elder or sister. They talked to people everywhere they went and handed many referrals to us for our teaching.

“But of all the superb accomplishments of this branch, one stands out: in eight months I worked there, I never took anyone to church who did not get baptized. The four elders in the city developed an almost clinical attitude about this. We knew that if we could get an investigator to a church meeting, our work was mostly done. The members demonstrated so much love and joy that people found them and the church the loved irresistible. These visitors would come to church wondering and a little nervous, and they would leave rejoicing and looking for a baptismal font.

“It is interesting to note that this little branch, on the verge of being closed in September of 1965 became a ward in the first stake in South America in May of 1966. Both the growth and the retention were stunning.” (Ted, L. Gibbons, “[Every Member a Missionary](#),” D&C Lesson #41.)

†11. President Gordon B. Hinckley: “It is not an easy thing to become a member of this Church. In most cases it involves setting aside old habits, leaving old friends and associations, and stepping into a new society which is different and somewhat demanding” (“[Converts and Young Men](#),” *Ensign*, May 1997, 47).

†12. President Gordon B. Hinckley: “I have said before, and I repeat it, that every new convert needs three things:

“1. A friend in the Church to whom he can constantly turn, who will walk beside him, who will answer his questions, who will understand his problems.

“2. An assignment. Activity is the genius of this Church. It is the process by which we grow. Faith and love for the Lord are like the muscle of my arm. If I use them, they grow stronger. If I put them in a sling, they become weaker. Every convert deserves a responsibility...

“3. Every convert must be “nourished by the good word of God” (Moro. 6:4). It is imperative that he or she become affiliated with a priesthood quorum or the Relief Society, the Young Women, the Young Men, the Sunday School, or the Primary. He or she must be encouraged to come to sacrament meeting to partake of the sacrament, to renew the covenants made at the time of baptism” (“[Find the Lambs, Feed the Sheep](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 107).

Recommended media:

1. Video: [Those Warned Must Warn Others](#) (1:15)
2. Video: [Come All Ye Sons of God](#) (1:30)
3. Video: [It's a Miracle](#) (1:30)
4. Video: [The Lord of the Harvest: The Adams Family](#) (4:41)

Further recommended reading:

1. Nancy Jensen, at Gospel Doctrine Plus, in [Lesson #41](#).

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